Sample Investigation Brief #1:

The risk score of 75 is driven by the customer's 6 returns out of 20 orders (a 30 % return rate), a total refund of $1,358.54 with $977.89 of refund inflation, the largest single inflation of $385.17, two returns filed before delivery, and one duplicate-order claim. Possible innocent explanations include a corporate client testing warranty coverage, legitimate product quality issues, or shipping errors that prompted multiple returns, especially if the items were damaged or not as described. The returns team should first verify each return against the original order details, confirm the condition of the returned items, audit the refund amounts against the product values, and check the shipping logs to confirm that the pre-delivery returns were indeed submitted before the items were delivered.

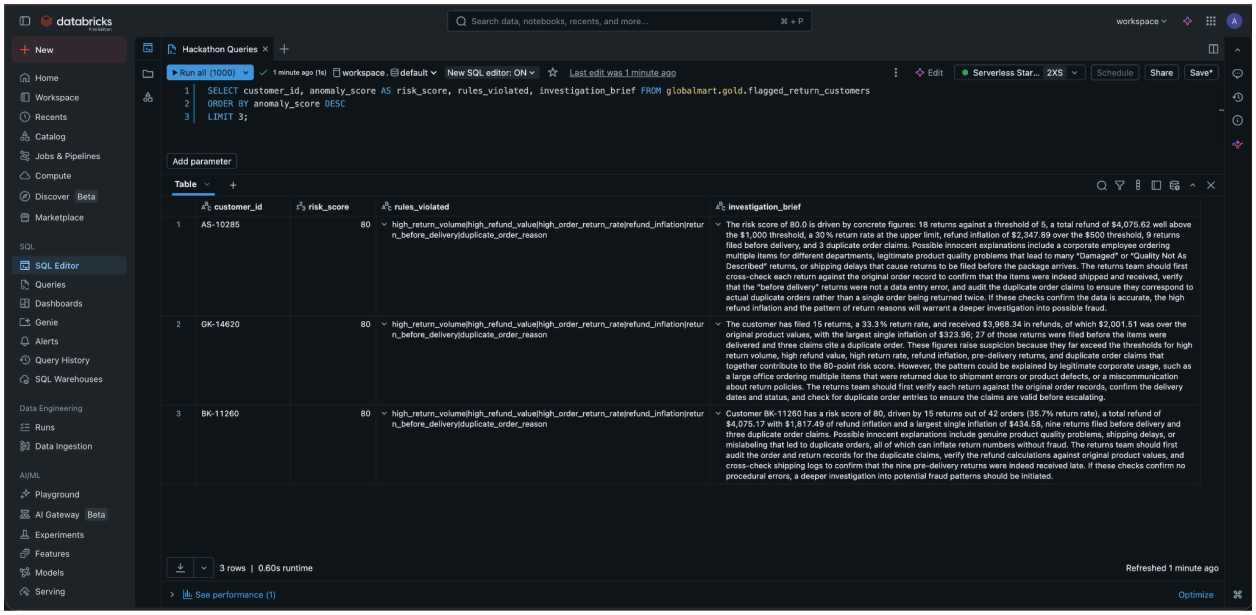
Sample Investigation Brief #2:

The return profile is flagged because the customer has five returns, a 33.3 % return rate, a total refund of $1,322.78, refund inflation of $667.17, three returns filed before delivery, and one duplicate-order claim, all of which hit or exceed the thresholds that contributed to the 75-point risk score. An innocent explanation could be that Grace Kelly is a corporate client who frequently orders high-value items that sometimes arrive damaged or late, prompting legitimate returns, or that a system glitch caused duplicate orders or mis-dated return submissions. The returns team should first verify the original order details against the return claims, confirm the shipping dates to ensure the "before delivery" returns are truly pre-delivery, and cross-check the refunded amounts with the original product prices to see if the $667.17 inflation can be justified by discounts, promotions, or shipping adjustments. If the data still shows unexplained inflation or duplicate orders, a deeper audit of the order creation and refund processes should follow.

Sample Investigation Brief #3:

Customer BK-11260 has a risk score of 75.0, with five returns out of 14 orders, a 35.7 % return rate, $1,850.63 refunded and $1,242.66 in refund inflation, including a largest single inflation of $434.58, three returns filed before delivery and one duplicate order claim. These figures could reflect legitimate issues such as repeated quality problems, late deliveries, or a customer mistakenly ordering the same item twice, which would explain the high return volume and refund inflation. The returns team should first verify each return against the original order details, confirm the product condition and reason codes, and cross-check shipping and delivery records to ensure the returns were indeed before delivery. If the returns match the order history and shipping data, the case may be a genuine customer complaint; if discrepancies appear, further investigation into potential fraud is warranted.

Sample Investigation Briefs:



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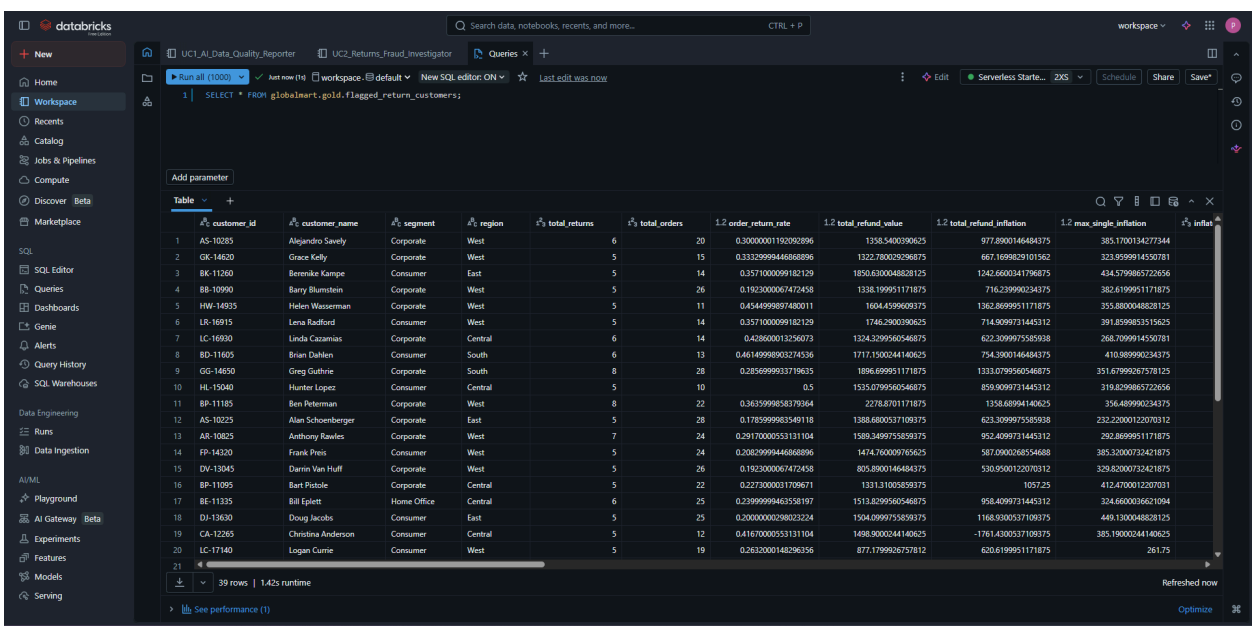

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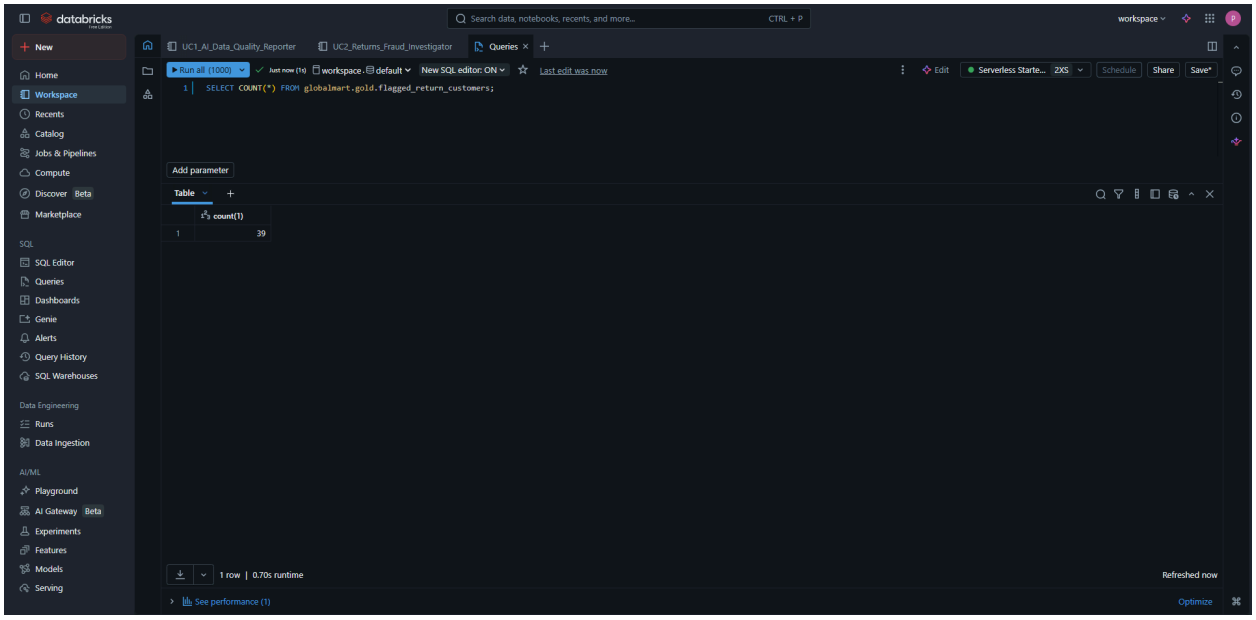

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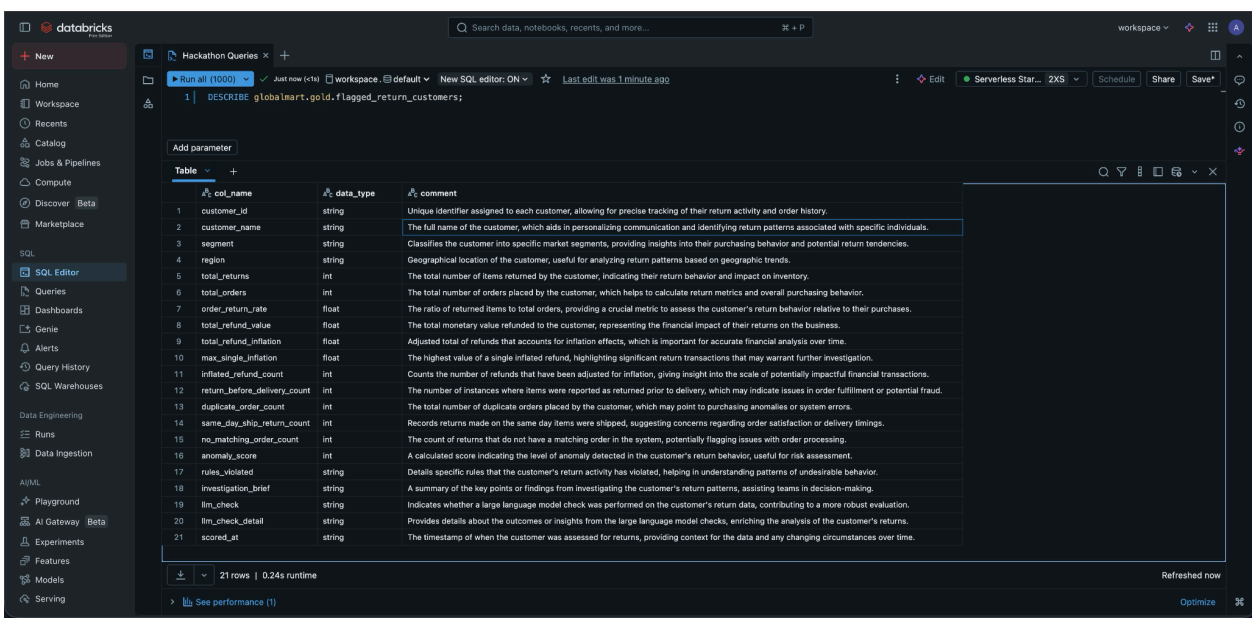

	col_name	data_type	comment
1	customer_id	string	Unique identifier assigned to each customer, allowing for precise tracking of their return activity and order history.
2	customer_name	string	The full name of the customer, which aids in personalizing communication and identifying return patterns associated with specific individuals.
3	segment	string	Classifies the customer into specific market segments, providing insights into their purchasing behavior and potential return tendencies.
4	region	string	Geographical location of the customer, useful for analyzing return patterns based on geographic trends.
5	total_returns	int	The total number of items returned by the customer, indicating their return behavior and impact on inventory.
6	total_orders	int	The total number of orders placed by the customer, which helps to calculate return metrics and overall purchasing behavior.
7	order_return_rate	float	The ratio of returned items to total orders, providing a crucial metric to assess the customer's return behavior relative to their purchases.
8	total_refund_value	float	The total monetary value refunded to the customer, representing the financial impact of their returns on the business.
9	total_refund_inflation	float	Adjusted total of refunds that accounts for inflation effects, which is important for accurate financial analysis over time.
10	max_single_inflation	float	The highest value of a single inflated refund, highlighting significant return transactions that may warrant further investigation.
11	inflated_refund_count	int	Counts the number of refunds that have been adjusted for inflation, giving insight into the scale of potentially impactful financial transactions.
12	return_before_delivery_count	int	The number of instances where items were reported as returned prior to delivery, which may indicate issues in order fulfillment or potential fraud.
13	duplicate_order_count	int	The total number of duplicate orders placed by the customer, which may point to purchasing anomalies or system errors.
14	same_day_ship_return_count	int	Records returns made on the same day items were shipped, suggesting concerns regarding order satisfaction or delivery timings.
15	no_matching_order_count	int	The count of returns that do not have a matching order in the system, potentially flagging issues with order processing.
16	anomaly_score	int	A calculated score indicating the level of anomaly detected in the customer's return behavior, useful for risk assessment.
17	rules_violated	string	Details specific rules that the customer's return activity has violated, helping in understanding patterns of undesirable behavior.
18	investigation_brief	string	A summary of the key points or findings from investigating the customer's return patterns, assisting teams in decision-making.
19	llm_check	string	Indicates whether a large language model check was performed on the customer's return data, contributing to a more robust evaluation.
20	llm_check_detail	string	Provides details about the outcomes or insights from the large language model checks, enriching the analysis of the customer's returns.
21	scored_at	string	The timestamp of when the customer was assessed for returns, providing context for the data and any changing circumstances over time.